

Oppo Find X9 Ultra

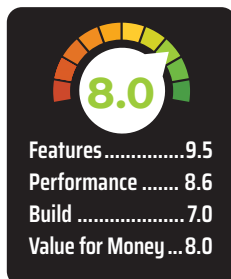
More camera than smartphone

There's a standard, there's the Pro, and then there's the Ultra. Why do phone makers tag their highest-end product as 'Ultra'? Derived from a Latin word *ultrā*, according to the Oxford dictionary, it means beyond, something which is extreme or exceeds its usual limit. Now, Oppo has done something extreme this time with the launch of its latest flagship phone, the Oppo Find X9 Ultra. This phone checks almost every box to be called Ultra. By the way, I've used a bunch of Ultra phones since 2020, and over a period of time, the meaning of this word has changed. Earlier, it mostly meant having better zoom or specs on the Ultra model. But now, these are the phones that are expected to do everything well: cameras, performance, battery life, display, gaming, software, and literally everything.

For this review, I didn't want to test the Oppo Find X9 Ultra the usual way. Instead of shooting near my office or house, I carried it across Rishikesh and Dharamshala, used it in various conditions, including bright sunlight, tricky sunsets, mountain landscapes, low-light street photography and also took the phone to an IPL match, just to understand one thing: does this phone actually deserve the Ultra title?

CAMERA

For me, the Oppo Find X9 Ultra feels slightly different because this is a phone that clearly wants to behave more like a camera than a smartphone with good cameras attached to it. So, as I mentioned above, instead of another normal camera test, I took this device to two cities, Rishikesh and Dharam-



shala. I shot with it in bright sunlight, in tricky lighting, sunsets, on the bus, and in low light, just to understand one thing: how good is this camera when you genuinely rely on it?

The Find X9 Ultra features cameras co-developed and tuned by Hasselblad. The main lens is a 200MP Sony LYT-901 with a large 1/1.12-inch sensor size and an f/1.5 aperture. This is paired with a 50MP Sony LYT-600 ultra-wide sensor with an f/2.0 aperture, a 200MP 3x telephoto OmniVision OV52A sensor with an f/2.2 aperture, the world's first 50MP 10x ultra-telephoto customised Samsung JNL sensor with an aperture of f/3.5, and a 3.2MP monochrome sensor with an aperture of f/2.4. On the front, you get a 50MP autofocus Samsung ISOCELL JN5 sensor with an f/2.4 aperture.

Now, for obvious reasons, the main camera is where the Find X9 Ultra is the strongest. In this poolside image, you can see that the tiny textures and shadows were retained in the lower section of the pool lounge. The phone does not aggressively smooth or sharpen the image unnecessarily. This image was captured in broad daylight in Rishikesh.

Similarly, when you look at the overall performance of the main camera, it retains texture and shadow details extremely well in photos.

Even difficult elements like darker foliage and water reflections stayed controlled. The colours are also balanced and look quite natural. However, there were some moments where the images kind of looked a bit over-sharpened, but most of the time, I was satisfied with the results.

For everyday photography, the experience stayed consistent and impressive. The Oppo Find X9 Ultra delivers crisp details and strong dynamic range in photos, but what really stands out is how reliable the camera is. I can confidently say that you can point and shoot with this device without worrying too much about the outcome.

Macro photography is also a strong area on the Find X9 Ultra. While walking around the pool area at my hotel in Rishikesh, I noticed a small bug on the ground, and I instantly took a picture, and the texture captured on the wings and body was impressive. There were fine details, and the image didn't look artificially sharpened.

I would say portrait photography is probably one of the key factors of getting the Find X9 Ultra. The images this phone takes look balanced and cinematic. If you zoom in on the shot, you could easily spot the details. The bokeh effect looks very natural, and hands down, for me, this is the best smartphone in the world, which has the best edge detection, period.

In this photo below, you can literally see every hair strand of the subject.